

DevOps 30-Day Interview Preparation

Day 05 - Linux Performance & Memory

Objectives

Learn CPU, memory, load average and production troubleshooting.

Commands

top - Real-time processes
free -h - Memory usage
uptime - Load average
ps aux --sort=-%cpu | head - Top CPU processes

Memory Tricks

top = Linux Task Manager
free -h = Memory overview
uptime = System load
ps aux = CPU heavy processes

Production Flow

Slow Website
Network → Server → CPU → Memory → Application → Logs → Root Cause → Fix

Common CPU Causes

Traffic spike
Infinite loop
Heavy background jobs
Expensive queries

Interview Questions

What does top show?
What does free -h show?
What is load average?
Why investigate before killing a process?

Engineering Mindset

Investigate → Collect Evidence → Root Cause → Fix → Verify → Prevent